When we got into the town, I had a good wait. Master's business kept him for a long time, so we could not start for home till late in the afternoon. By then, the wind was much stronger and I heard Master say to John that he had never been out in such a bad storm. We went through a wood where great branches were swaying about like twigs and the wind made a terrible rushing sound.

"I wish we were out of this wood," said my master.



"Yes, sir," replied John. "I hope no branches fall down on us," The words were hardly out of his mouth when there was a **groan** and a splitting sound. Then an Oak tree that had been torn up by the roots came crashing down and fell right across the road in front of us.

I will never say I was not frightened of, for I was. I stopped still trembling. Of course, I did not turn around or run away. I was not brought up like that. John jumped out and in a moment was standing by my head. He held my **bridle** and calmed my nerves.

"That was close! What shall we do now?" asked my master.

"Well, sir, we can't drive over this big tree and we can't get round it. We must go back to four cross ways. Then it will be about six miles before we get to the wooden bridge again. It will make us late, but black beauty is fresh."

8th_english_4 to 6.indd 144 16-12-2022 14:25:35